



B.R.A.D - Privacy Policy

Bot to Report Abusive Domains

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: October 2025

Entity: Hello world! Inc

Contact email: cos301.cap2@gmail.com

Disclaimer: B.R.A.D is a research and demonstration system developed for academic purposes only. It is not intended for commercial or production use, and all data submitted is used solely for research and educational evaluation

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1. Introduction

At BRAD, we are committed to protecting your privacy and ensuring that your personal information is processed in compliance with the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA), 2013. This Privacy Policy explains how we collect, use, store, and protect personal information when you use our system. Disclaimer: B.R.A.D is a research and demonstration system developed for academic purposes only. It is not intended for commercial or production use, and all data submitted is used solely for research and educational evaluation.

2. Information We Collect

We may collect and process the following categories of personal information:

- **Identification Information:** Name and surname
- **Contact Information:** Email address
- **Account Credentials:** Username and Password (securely hashed and never stored in plain text)
- **System Data:** Logs, usage analytics, and cookies
- **Uploaded Content:** Screenshots, attachments, or files submitted as part of investigation reports

3. Purpose of Processing Personal Information

We collect and use your personal information for the following legitimate purposes:

- To create and authenticate your user account
- To facilitate communication related to domain investigations and reports
- To maintain system analytics, performance, and security auditing
- To ensure compliance with applicable laws and institutional research ethics
- To improve the reliability and research outcomes of the BRAD platform

We do not use your information for direct marketing or commercial gain.

4. Legal Basis for Processing

Processing of personal information is based on one or more of the following legal grounds under POPIA: Your explicit consent when registering an account. The necessity to perform academic and research functions. The legitimate interest in maintaining and securing the BRAD system Compliance with legal and institutional obligations.

5. Data Storage and Retention

All personal data is securely stored in databases and systems managed by BRAD for the duration of the research project. Passwords are hashed before storage using strong cryptographic algorithms. Your data will be retained only as long as necessary for academic and evaluation purposes, after which it may be anonymized or deleted.

6. Data Security

We implement appropriate technical and organizational safeguards to protect personal data, including encrypted data transmission (HTTPS/TLS), secure password hashing, access controls, regular security audits, and isolation of uploaded files in controlled storage. Although no system can guarantee absolute security, BRAD follows best-practice principles for data protection in academic research environments.

7. Sharing of Information

We do not sell, rent, or trade personal data. Personal information may be shared only with authorized research team members or system maintainers where necessary to maintain platform functionality, conduct security or performance analysis, or comply with applicable academic or legal obligations. All access is logged and restricted to authorized personnel.

8. Your Rights

Under POPIA, you have the following rights:

- Access: Request a copy of your personal data
- Correction: Request corrections to inaccurate or outdated information
- Deletion: Request deletion or anonymization of your data
- Withdrawal of Consent: Withdraw your consent to processing at any time
- Objection: Object to specific uses of your data under certain conditions

To exercise these rights, contact us at **cos301.cap2@gmail.com**.

9. Cookies and Analytics

We may use limited cookies and analytics tools to collect non-personal, aggregated data on user activity to improve system usability and security. These cookies do not track or identify individual users.

10. Updates To this Policy

We may update this Privacy Policy periodically to reflect changes in our system or compliance requirements. All updates will be published at <https://capstone-brad.dns.net.za/privacy> with a revised effective date.

11. Contact Information

If you have any questions or concerns about this Privacy Policy, contact us at:

BRAD Privacy Team

Email: cos301.cap2@gmail.com

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